DAY 3 WORKSHEET — YOUR FIRST AUTOMATION

Automation = work that happens on a trigger instead of on your time. Design it as Trigger → Brain → Action, run it once, and keep yourself in the loop.

NAME: _____ DATE: _____

01 MAP THE MANUAL WORKFLOW

You can't automate what you can't describe. Pick one repetitive task (email triage is tonight's build) and write how you do it by hand today, step by step.

The task I'm automating:

How I currently do it manually (every step):

Roughly how much time it eats per week:

02 DESIGN IT — TRIGGER / BRAIN / ACTION

TRIGGER — what kicks it off:

BRAIN — the full instruction you give Claude (yes, it's a 6-part prompt — Day 2 pays off here):

ACTION — where the result goes (remember: draft for approval, never auto-send):

03 CONNECT AND RUN

- [ ] I connected the app(s) — authorized the connector or pasted the API key.
- [ ] The API key moment happened and nobody had to write code.
- [ ] I ran the automation once, end to end.
- [ ] The output landed as a DRAFT for my approval — human-in-the-loop, always.

What the first run produced (and one thing you fixed after it):

04 THE STRATEGIST'S ANSWER

A client asks: "So is the AI just sending emails as you?" Write the answer that keeps their trust.

Your answer:

Next automation you'd build with the same Trigger → Brain → Action shape:

COACH'S NOTE — If your plan gates you from running it live tonight, design everything here and execute from the replay — the design IS the skill.